

DataCentre Allocator

Server Resource Management System

BACKEND

Flask · Python 3.11

DATABASE

MongoDB Atlas

FRONTEND

HTML · CSS · JS

TESTS

103 Passing

V1.1 Base Init

V1.2 Server Mgmt

V1.3 Workload Enhancements

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github.com/Sriram-Selvaperumal/tactive-assignment

What is this project?

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Data centres run dozens of workloads across many servers. Without automated resource management, operators manually assign tasks — leading to waste, overloaded servers, and stranded capacity.

This system automates that: register servers, queue workloads, and let

SOLUTION

- **Servers:** Register physical/virtual machines with CPU and RAM capacity
- **Workloads:** Define tasks with resource requirements (CPU cores + RAM MB)
- **Allocator:** Automatically assign workloads to the best available server
- **Lifecycle:** Manage server states — Online, Offline, Maintenance — with auto eviction

SERVER

CPU + RAM

capacity pool

WORKLOAD

CPU + RAM

resource request

ALLOCATION

Workload →

Server assignment

BACKEND

Flask 3.1

Lightweight WSGI web framework

Python 3.11+

Type-annotated, dataclass-driven

python-dotenv

Environment variable management

Werkzeug

WSGI utilities and request handling

DATABASE

MongoDB Atlas

Cloud-hosted NoSQL document store

pymongo 4.10

Official MongoDB Python driver

3 Collections

servers · workloads · allocations

Unique Indexes

Enforce name uniqueness + alloc guard

FRONTEND

Vanilla HTML/CSS

No framework dependencies

Vanilla JS

fetch() API, DOM rendering

SPA Architecture

Single page, zero full reloads

Responsive UI

Clean, minimal, card-based layout

TESTING

pytest 8.3

Test runner and assertion library

pytest-flask

Flask test client integration

103 Tests

All green on final run

Integration tests

Black-box, full-stack, no mocking

Browser (Client)

index.html · style.css · app.js

HTTP / JSON →

Routes Layer

Flask Blueprints · Input validation · Response formatting

calls →

Service Layer

AllocationService · Business rules · Best-Fit algorithm

calls →

Repository Layer

ServerRepo · WorkloadRepo · AllocationRepo

queries →

MongoDB Atlas (Cloud)

datacenter_db · servers · workloads · allocations

Rule 1

ONLINE Only

Only servers with status ONLINE are eligible

Rule 2

CPU Sufficiency

$\text{available_cpu} \geq \text{workload.cpu_required}$

Rule 3

RAM Sufficiency

$\text{available_ram} \geq \text{workload.ram_required}$

Rule 4

Both Required

CPU AND RAM must both pass — not either alone

Rule 5

No Partial Allocation

If ineligible, nothing is written — state unchanged

Rule 6

No Duplicate

Allocated workload cannot be assigned again

Rule 7

Best-Fit Selection

Server with smallest remaining slack is chosen

Rule 8

Resource Accounting

allocated_cpu and allocated_ram updated on server

Rule 9

Status Consistency

Workload transitions PENDING → ALLOCATED

Rule 10

Input Validation

Missing or bad workload_id → 400 Bad Request

m

Best-Fit Algorithm

SCORING FORMULA

$$\text{score} = (\text{available_cpu} - \text{required_cpu}) + (\text{available_ram} - \text{required_ram})$$

Minimum score wins. Tie-broken by oldest registered server.

WORKED EXAMPLE — Workload needs 4 CPU + 8,192 MB RAM

Server	Avail. CPU	Avail. RAM	Score	Selected?
Server A	16	32,768 MB	24,588	—
Server B	8	16,384 MB	8,196	—
Server C	4	8,192 MB	0	✓ SELECTED

WHY BEST-FIT?

- Maximises cluster utilisation — fills servers before opening new ones
- Deterministic and predictable — easy to reason about and verify with tests
- Simple to explain — lower score = tighter pack = better efficiency

REST API Endpoints

SERVERS

POST	/api/servers	Create a new server	201
GET	/api/servers	List all servers	200
GET	/api/servers/<id>	Get server by ID	200
PATCH	/api/servers/<id>/status	Update server status + evict	200
DELETE	/api/servers/<id>	Delete server + evict workloads	200

WORKLOADS

POST	/api/workloads	Create a new workload (PENDING)	201
GET	/api/workloads	List all workloads	200
GET	/api/workloads/<id>	Get workload by ID	200
PATCH	/api/workloads/<id>	Modify CPU / RAM allocation	200
DELETE	/api/workloads/<id>	Delete workload + free resources	200

ALLOCATIONS

POST	/api/allocations	Submit workload for allocation	201
GET	/api/allocations/<id>	Get allocation record by ID	200
GET	/api/health	Health check endpoint	200

MongoDB Collections & Domain Models

servers	workloads	allocations
name Unique server identifier string	name Unique workload identifier string	workload_id Reference to workload document ref
cpu_capacity Total CPU cores int	cpu_required CPU cores needed int	server_id Reference to server document ref
ram_capacity Total RAM in MB int	ram_required RAM needed in MB int	created_at Timestamp of allocation datetime
status ONLINE / OFFLINE / MAINTENANCE enum	status PENDING / ALLOCATED enum	
allocated_cpu CPU currently in use int		
allocated_ram RAM currently in use (MB) int		

COMPUTED PROPERTIES ON SERVER MODEL

$available_cpu = cpu_capacity - allocated_cpu$

$available_ram = ram_capacity - allocated_ram$

$cpu_utilisation_pct = (allocated_cpu / cpu_capacity) \times 100$

103 Tests. Zero Failures.

103	3	15	100%
Total Tests	Test Modules	Test Classes	Pass Rate

test_allocations.py	TestRule1OnlineOnly	ONLINE-only server filtering
	TestRule4BothResourcesMatter	CPU AND RAM both required
	TestRule5NoPartialAllocation	Atomicity — no partial writes
	TestRule6NoDuplicateAllocation	Concurrency guard
	TestRule7BestFitStrategy	Best-fit server selection
	TestRule8ResourceAccounting	Allocated counter accuracy
	TestServerStatusChangeEvictsWorkloads	Eviction on status change
	TestWorkloadDeletionFreesResources	Resource release on delete
	TestModifyAllocatedWorkloadResources	Delta capacity accounting
test_servers.py	TestCreateServer, TestUpdateServerStatus, TestDeleteServer	
test_workloads.py	TestCreateWorkload, TestUpdateWorkloadResources, TestDeleteWorkload	

✓ 103 passed in 115.14s (0:01:55) — All green, every rule validated

What was delivered

V1.1

Base Initialization

- Layered Flask architecture
- 10 allocation business rules
- Best-fit scheduling engine
- MongoDB Atlas integration
- Single-page frontend UI
- 58 passing tests

V1.2

Server Status & Workload Management

- Server status transitions (Online/Offline/Maintenance)
- Server deletion endpoint
- Automatic workload eviction with resource reset
- Compensating transaction pattern
- 93 passing tests

V1.3

Workload Management Enhancements

- Workload deletion with resource release
- Modify CPU/RAM of existing workloads
- Delta capacity accounting for allocated workloads
- Edit/Delete UI controls
- 103 passing tests

ENGINEERING PRINCIPLES APPLIED

Separation of Concerns

Routes / Service / Repository / Model — each layer has one job

Typed Error Model

Service raises exceptions; routes map them to HTTP codes

Integration Testing

Black-box tests over HTTP — no mocking, full-stack confidence

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